W a v e f o r m 2 0 0 1

Australasian Computer Music Association Conference
July 12-14, 2001
School of Contemporary Arts
University of Western Sydney
Australia

Introduction

Waveform 2001 is a conference exploring recent research, development, composition and performance in the field of digital musics. The conference will include concerts, paper sessions, artist talks, discussion panels and reports. It aims to strengthen the links between practice (composition, performance, technical research), and theory and criticism (listening, evaluation, contextualisation), balancing the all important minutiae of the creative and studio processes with examinations of the complex and diverse macro structure of current digital music practice.

The world wide web, galloping clock speeds, real time processing/modelling, and a realisation of the concept of 'desktop audio' have contributed to produce a rich and intensely varied body of work, well beyond the confines of the traditional university computer music studio. Digital music is neither a style nor a genre; it is simply music for which the use of a computer is necessary – or at least central – to its genesis. Traditionally, there has been a division of activity between the so-called academic electro-acoustic music scene and experimental digital music scene occurring on the fringes of the popular music community. This conference seeks to encourage and develop a dialogue between these spheres of activity, therefore submissions from artists working across the full range of digital musics are welcome. To facilitate this, a range of presentation contexts will be provided, ranging from a formal concert/critical audio environment, through foyer spaces, outside locations, the world wide web and fm radio, to more informal club/bar type environments.

Submission deadline for fully refereed papers

Friday April 6, 2001

Submission deadline for all other categories

Friday April 27, 2001

Call for musical works

The conference committee welcomes the submission of works for recorded media or live performance with any combination of electronic and acoustic elements. Available playback formats will include CD, DVD, DAT, Mini Disc, ADAT, DA88, and sound file/disk based playback. In addition to audio playback there will be VHS, SVHS and MiniDV decks and video/data projection. A wide selection of microphones is available for live amplification and the School of Contemporary Arts offers a full range, tunable six channel playback system to accommodate multi-channel works. Two further channels may be added with similar, but non-identical, components.

Works employing video, installation and the world wide web are also encouraged where audio is given primacy, or at least equal status with vision.

Some potential areas of focus are

- Music generated from microphone captured audio and 'found sound'
- Music generated from pure digital synthesis procedures
- Spatial audio and virtual sonic architecture
- Machine listening and interactivity, autonomous audio, performance over computer networks
- The laptop computer as musical instrument, 'lo-fi', post-beat dance musics.
- Computer processed voice, speech synthesis, text pieces.

The availability of acoustic performers for works is limited and performance of works is subject to the availability of required players.

Call for fully refereed papers

Full copies of conference papers for peer review and publication in the conference proceedings are requested. The refereeing process will satisfy the eligibility requirements for inclusion in publication quanta for Australian Universities.

Submission instructions are detailed below. Please note the earlier deadline for refereed papers.

Call for non-refereed papers

Individuals making proposals under this category should submit an abstract only. These papers will have non-refereed status and will be selected by the organising committee on the basis of the submitted abstracts and their relevance to themes as they develop.

Note: Papers under this category will be published in full in the conference proceedings if suitable final drafts are received by the due date (see above).

Topics for papers may include, but are not limited to:

Technical

- Software and hardware development
- The integration of audio with other media in digital environments
- Sound spatialisation and virtual audio systems
- Machine listening and composing/interactive music systems
- Artificial life and autonomous audio systems
- Sound synthesis and digital signal processing

Non-Technical

- Critical analyses of works or compositional trends
- Socio-cultural, economic and political aspects of digital music making
- The relationships between academic computer music and recent popular music
- Net radio and emerging internet digital music cultures
- New investigations into historical developments in electronic and computer music
- The recent proliferation of 'lo-fi' production strategies in digital musics
- Notions of hybridity in digital musics

Organisers would particularly like to encourage submissions from members of the wider academic/music community for the non-technical category. It is envisaged that the non-technical session/s will appeal to a musically literate but non-technically expert audience. It is the intention that the non-technical papers strengthen the links between theory, criticism and practice.

Artist talks/reports

We wish to explicitly encourage opportunities for artists to discuss previous, ongoing or developing projects, with particular emphasis on projects that relate to the conference themes. Submissions from studios/centres and artist organisations/co-operatives are also encouraged.

Submission Instructions

Please go to http://www.acma.asn.au/ and download the submission templates. If you have trouble accessing these templates, please email Julian Knowles mailto:j.knowles@uws.edu.au

Registration

Early Registration (post marked by Friday April 27, 2001)
ACMA Member AUD$170.00
Non-Member AUD$190.00
Student /unemployed AUD$90.00
Conference dinner (not included in registration) AUD$30.00

Normal Registration (post marked by Friday June 29, 2001)
ACMA Member AUD$200.00
Non-Member AUD$220.00
Student/unemployed AUD$110.00
Conference dinner (not included in registration) AUD$30.00

On-Site Registration
ACMA Member AUD$220.00
Non-Member AUD$240.00
Student/unemployed AUD$130.00
Conference dinner (not included in registration) AUD$30.00

Day Registration
ACMA Member AUD$75
Non-Member AUD$85

All payments due in Australian dollars. Cheques or money orders should be made payable to the *Australasian Computer Music Conference.* For current international exchange rates, try Yahoo Finance Currency Converter.

Registration fees include a copy of the ACMC 2001 Proceedings, the ACMC 2001 Conference CD ROM, lunches & refreshments, and admission to all concerts and paper sessions.

Contact Details

ACMA Conference 2001
Julian Knowles
Co-ordinator of Music Technology and Electronic Arts
School of Contemporary Arts (Music), University of Western Sydney
Locked Bag 1797, Penrith South DC, NSW 1797
AUSTRALIA

mailto:j.knowles@uws.edu.au

Ph: +61 247 360 162

Fax: +61 247 360 166

Web: http://acma.asn.au/